Presenter A

Slides 1 to 3
Opening and strategic assessment
5 minutes

You set the frame. The committee is split on cloud versus on-premise, so do not take a side yet. Your job is to establish why the firm should act at all and that the sector has already moved.

1 Title and opening

- Name the split in the room in one sentence, so the committee hears that we understood the actual disagreement.
- Say what the next 25 minutes deliver: a decision, its business case, its risk boundary and a plan.
- Promise the number that matters: we are asking for **EUR 12,000**, not for the full programme.

2 Why invest in AI, and why now

- The twenty people are the constraint. Search and preparation absorb hours that clients never pay for, and the firm cannot hire its way out at this size.
- AI is bought here as **capacity**, not as a new service. That distinction carries the whole deck.
- The resource-based argument: foundation models are a commodity any competitor can buy. Curated, legitimately reusable case knowledge plus experienced auditors is what cannot be copied.
- Say the limit out loud before anyone asks: client reports must never become an unrestricted cross-client knowledge pool. Reuse needs permission or verified anonymisation.
- On waiting: the prerequisites take calendar time whether we start now or in a year. Client ICT agreements, accreditation notice and auditor competence do not compress.

3 Competitive landscape

- Two peers run internal assistants on retrieval over their own standards and past reports. Both chose business cloud over local hardware, which is independent confirmation of our architecture.
- Be honest about the evidence: these are self-reported. **No competitor has published a measured productivity return.** Our case therefore rests on our own numbers, not on theirs.
- Separate the two games. Selling AI assurance is a service decision and needs accreditation we do not have. Using AI inside the audit is an efficiency decision and is open to us today.
- If asked about ISO/IEC 42001: becoming an accredited certification body for it is out of reach at twenty people. Auditor competence to audit AI-using clients sits inside our existing scope and costs training only.
- Hand over to Presenter B with the question their slide answers: where exactly in our process does this land?

> **Watch for:** do not quote a benefit figure. Silas owns every number on slide 8 and the committee should hear each figure once.

Presenter B

Slides 4 and 9
Operations and organisational readiness
5 minutes

You own the two slides that decide whether this is realistic. Both answer the same underlying question from different sides: can this firm absorb AI as it works today?

4 Operations and process impact

- State the honest basis: the process map is a hypothesis from the case. Interviews and time measurements in weeks 1 and 2 establish the real workflow before anybody commits.
- The chips carry the answer the case asks for. **Two steps accelerate, two need redesign first.** Preparation and fieldwork can start on today's process; document review and reporting cannot.
- What redesign means concretely for document review: every document needs a mandatory ID, version, client, requirement and owner. Without that, retrieval returns plausible but unprovable matches.
- For reporting: observation, criterion, evidence and conclusion have to be separate fields. Today they are one narrative, and a draft cannot be checked against a narrative.
- A new permanent step, not a saving: every affected report must record the extent and effectiveness of the AI use. That is an accreditation requirement, and it is a template change rather than a judgement change.
- On fieldwork, the hard line: no emotion, sentiment or credibility inference on auditee staff. Several transcription tools ship that switched on, and it is a prohibited practice.

9 Organisational readiness

- The headline is the answer: twenty people can **own** a managed platform, nobody here can **run** one. Ownership is content and rules; running is patching, backup, restore tests and cover.
- Two red cells decide it. Platform operation and availability are absent today and cannot be bought internally, only contracted.
- Put a number on the internal cost: 0.05 FTE under cloud is about two hours a week. Under on-premise it is 0.15 FTE plus content duties, which at this size means a named person loses a day a fortnight.
- One enthusiastic employee is not an operating model. Say it plainly; it is the single most common failure mode for firms this size.
- On resistance, be concrete rather than reassuring: experienced auditors may read this as a judgement on their speed. The counter is structural, not verbal. Two practitioners design the test set, and released time funds quality before it funds targets, so reporting a saving never costs anyone anything.
- Access rights get corrected before switch-on. Retrieval respects permissions, so it exposes whatever over-permissioning already exists.

> **Watch for:** do not pre-empt Presenter C on consent or the DPIA. Say the process needs a redesign and let them carry why.

Presenter C

Slides 5, 11 and 12
Risk, pilot and governance
5 minutes

You carry the committee's actual fear and then defuse it with a plan. The pivot of the whole presentation is on your first slide: risk decides which documents enter, not which model we buy.

5 Confidentiality and risk

- Lead with the weighting logic the case demands: apply exclusion criteria first, then compare benefit, cost and residual risk among whatever survives. A weighted scorecard would imply a precision this case does not support.
- The layer that binds hardest is contractual, not regulatory. The certification standard forbids disclosing client information to a third party without written consent, and the ICT rules require a prior mutual agreement with each audited client before AI touches their audit.
- Consequence the committee must hear: **eligibility is partly outside our control.** If a client refuses, the manual method is mandatory for that client. Weeks 1 and 2 size this in hours.
- On the asymmetry: regulatory fines are capped and, for an SME, capped at the lower of two tiers. Accreditation withdrawal and the client indemnity are uncapped. That is why we spend on the gate and on client agreements rather than on a server.
- Concede the strongest counter-argument yourself. The French regulator does recommend on-premise for sensitive documentation in retrieval systems. We follow it where it bites, because the restricted class never leaves the building.
- ISO 45001 evidence contains occupational-health data, so a data-protection impact assessment is required before client files are indexed. It is budgeted and done in weeks 1 and 2.

11 Pilot and phased rollout

- Why this pilot is low-risk: weeks 3 to 6 use internal procedures and synthetic cases only. No real client file enters the system until a written agreement exists.
- The ten deliberately unanswerable questions are the important half of the test set. We are measuring whether the system refuses, not only whether it answers.
- The economic gate is 2.5 net hours, deliberately above the 1.95 hour break-even, so a pass still survives a cost overrun of a quarter.
- Weeks 1 and 2 also start the clock on things we do not control: the ICT annex to the certification agreement and the letter to the accreditation body.

12 Governance and success measures

- Every row has a named owner. If the committee remembers one thing, it is that nothing here is owned by "IT" in general.
- The measures are built so that honesty is free. Released time funds quality first, so an auditor who reports a saving does not lose anything by reporting it.
- Refusal is a normal answer. A client who declines the ICT annex stays on the manual process and is not a failure of the programme.
- Close by handing the economics to Silas: we have shown it is safe and deliverable, he shows whether it pays.

Presenter D

Slides 6, 7 and 10
Technology options and scalability
5 minutes

You answer the question the board is actually arguing about. Be even-handed on slide 6, concrete on slide 7, and do not quote totals. Those belong to Silas on the slide straight after yours.

6 Cloud versus on-premise

- Give on-premise its win properly. Data protection is a genuine advantage, and it is the only criterion where it wins.
- Then make the central point: on-premise does not remove risk, it moves it. The provider disappears and patching, insider access, backups and outages arrive. At twenty people, total risk can rise.
- Scalability is about increments, not ceilings. Cloud grows per user; local grows in hardware steps, and one server is not high availability.
- Hybrid is not a middle way. It needs both operating capabilities and adds routing errors. It becomes the answer only if a client contractually requires local processing.
- If challenged on sovereignty: French guidance recommends qualified sovereign hosting for public-cloud AI, and our provider does not hold that qualification. A client who requires it is automatically ineligible for the cloud route, and that is a named trigger for hybrid.

7 Concrete technical solutions

- These are procurement proposals, not quotations or performance guarantees. Say so once, early.
- The three free settings are the sharpest part of the slide. Disabling web search, disallowing flex routing and pinning the deployment to an EU region cost nothing and close the known egress paths.
- Why the licence and the assistant are separate decisions: office licences do not include the audit retrieval system. We could buy one without the other, and the pilot tests the assistant.
- The open-weight model carries no licence fee, which is why the on-premise gap is hardware and operations, not software.
- End on reversibility: the cloud configuration can be switched off, hardware cannot be unbought. We keep a current quote on file so the on-premise path stays open at month twelve.

10 Future scalability

- Correct the intuitive error: tripling documents does not triple the bill. Volume drives indexing and storage; active users and answer length drive usage cost.
- The binding constraint is not technology. Faster research only raises throughput if expert review capacity grows with it, otherwise the queue simply moves.
- International expansion is a contracts problem before it is a technology problem. Client agreements are renegotiated per jurisdiction and quality is tested per language.
- At fifty employees two separate thresholds arrive, in cybersecurity obligations and in staff consultation duties. The doubling scenario stops at forty, so they sit just outside this plan.

Silas Zamzow

Slides 8, 13 and 14

Financial analysis, RAG and the recommendation

5 minutes

You own every number and the close. The credibility of the whole presentation rests on how openly you state what the figures are and are not.

8 Three-year total cost of ownership

- Say the qualifier before the figures, not after: these are planning assumptions, not measured savings, and the pilot exists to replace them.
- The benefit is released **capacity**. It turns into money only as additional deliverable work or avoided overtime and outsourcing. It is not a payroll reduction, and we are not proposing one.
- The sensitivity that matters most: at 40 per cent economic capture instead of 60, three-year net value is EUR 2,064, which is break-even. Everything above that is a judgement about demand.
- Be precise about where savings are capturable. Audit time inside accredited mandates is governed and billed, so hours saved there show up as quality and avoided overtime. We claim the capture factor only on preparation, knowledge work and internal support.
- The switch point, stated before anyone finds it: below roughly 64 per cent cloud-eligible workload, on-premise wins on our own numbers. That is why month twelve is a dated re-decision and not a formality.
- Hybrid never wins at any eligibility level. It is the one option the arithmetic rules out rather than merely disfavours.

13 Retrieval-augmented generation

- Answer the committee's question directly: yes, build it, from month four, once the pilot gates pass.
- The difference from uploading files to a chatbot is operating discipline, not the algorithm. Maintained sources, client separation, version control, deletion rules and a tested answer set.
- Permissions are enforced before results are selected, in the retrieval step. Telling a model to respect permissions in its instructions is not a control.
- State the limit clearly, because it protects us later: with cloud retrieval the selected passages still leave the internal network. It improves traceability and does not protect confidentiality.
- A correct citation is not a correct conclusion. Expert review stays in the workflow for exactly that reason.

14 Recommendation

- Name the assumption out loud. The case does not state a long-term strategy, so we assumed one, wrote it down and tested every recommendation against it: stay an independent specialist competing on trust, and grow capacity without growing headcount.
- Invite correction. If management's actual strategy is growth by scale or price, the recommendation changes, and we would rather hear that now than after the pilot.
- Repeat the ask precisely: approve EUR 12,000 and name the internal product owner. Nothing else is being decided today.
- Give the on-premise faction its due. They have a dated gate, a measurable trigger and a live quotation. They have not lost the argument, they have a scheduled rematch with evidence.
- Finish on the sentence the committee should repeat afterwards: we buy capacity, we keep the confidential documents out, and we check in twelve weeks.